

or `sudoedit /etc/sudoers`, this is not recommended. Instead, the command `sudo visudo` (short for `vi sudo`) is the preferred approach. The `visudo` command ensures that only one person edits the file at a time. It also checks for syntax errors before installing the new file. (The last thing you need is to corrupt `/etc/sudoers` and lose the ability to run `sudo` for fixing the problem.)

The default `/etc/sudoers` file gives access to everyone who is part of the `admin` group. Non-admin users are blocked from running commands as root. If you want to add someone to the `admin` group, use:

1. Use the `vigr` command to edit the `/etc/groups` file.
2. `sudo vigr`
3. The `/etc/groups` file lists each group name, group ID number, and a comma-separated list of users. Search for the line that begins with `admin`. It should list one account name (your default Ubuntu account). For example, my default account name is `neal` and the line says:
4. `admin:x:112:anot`
5. Add the new user name to this line. Use a comma to separate usernames. For example, if I want to add the user `marc` to this line, I would have:
6. `admin:x:112:anot,subeit`
7. Save your changes and quit the editor.

If you want to give a user Sudo access without adding them to a group, then you can add them as a privileged user.

1. Edit the `/etc/suders` file using `sudo visudo`.
2. Look for the line that says `root ALL=(ALL) ALL`.
3. Create a similar line with the user's account name. For example, if I want to give the account "`jck`" access, I will use:
4. `root ALL=(ALL) ALL`
5. `jck ALL=(ALL) ALL`

This addition says that the users "`root`" and "`jck`" can use `sudo` and can run any command with root privileges.

6. Save your changes and exit the `visudo` command.

Tweaking other Sudo Options

The default `sudo` command has three options enabled: `!lecture`, `tty_tickets`, and `!fqdn`. These options are flags-the `!` in front of any flag disables the option. Other options can be added that include values. All the options belong on the `Defaults` line in the `/etc/suders` file (use `sudo visudo` to edit this file). Some command options that you might want to tweak include:

`lecture`

When this flag is enabled, the `sudo` command will display a warning